

SSA Application Assistance — Adult Complete Worksheet: SSI, SSDI & DAC

For adults applying for disability — including young adults turning 18. Use it together with the Adult step-by-step video in this package.

Southern Oak Financial & Wellness • southernoakfw.org

Part 1 — The Three Programs, In Plain Language

SSI (Supplemental Security Income) — for people with limited income and resources who are disabled (or blind, or 65+). You do not need work history. The resource limit is \$2,000 for an individual, not counting the home you live in and usually one vehicle.

SSDI (Social Security Disability Insurance) — for people who worked and paid into Social Security and earned enough credits. The payment amount depends on your past earnings.

DAC (Disabled Adult Child benefits) — for an adult whose disability began before age 22, paid on a PARENT's earnings record when that parent has retired, become disabled, or passed away. Many young adults who age out of child SSI can qualify for DAC later — it often pays more than SSI and can lead to Medicare. Ask Social Security about it directly; it is commonly missed.

The disability test for adults: your condition must keep you from doing substantial work and must have lasted (or be expected to last) at least 12 months. Social Security uses a 5-step review and looks hard at your past work and whether other work is realistic for you.

Part 2 — About You

Full name

Date of birth

Social Security number

Phone and email

Mailing address

Diagnoses / conditions

Date you stopped working
(or reduced hours)

Are you applying for: SSI /
SSDI / DAC (circle)

If DAC: parent's name and
status (retired, disabled,
deceased)

Part 3 — Documents Checklist

- ☐ Birth certificate and Social Security card; proof of citizenship or legal status
- ☐ Medical records — every doctor, hospital, clinic, and therapist, with visit dates
- ☐ Medication list — name, dose, who prescribed it, and side effects
- ☐ Work history — jobs from the last 5 years: employer, dates, duties, lifting, standing, skills
- ☐ For SSI: proof of income and resources — bank statements, pay stubs, benefits letters
- ☐ For SSDI: most recent tax return or W-2 (helps confirm your earnings record)
- ☐ For DAC: your parent's Social Security information and proof of their retirement, disability, or death
- ☐ School records (young adults): IEPs, 504 plans, transition assessments, final school records
- ☐ Names and contact information for people who know how your condition affects you daily

Part 4 — How to Apply, Step by Step

Step 1 — Protect your filing date. Start the application right away: online at ssa.gov, by phone at 1-800-772-1213 (TTY 1-800-325-0778), or in person at your local office. The date you start can affect how much back pay you receive.

Step 2 — Check which programs to file for. Ask Social Security to check you for SSI, SSDI, AND DAC if a parent is retired, disabled, or deceased and your disability began before 22. Filing for one does not always file for the others — ask and write down the answer.

Step 3 — Complete the Adult Disability Report. List every condition together, every provider, and every medicine. Social Security must consider all of your conditions combined.

Step 4 — Complete the Work History Report. Describe each job from the last 5 years honestly: what you lifted, how long you stood or sat, the skills it took. Past work is a big part of the adult decision.

Step 5 — Complete the Function Report. This is your daily-life story: what a typical day looks like, what you can no longer do, and what help you need. Use Part 5 of this worksheet to prepare.

Step 6 — Keep treatment going and answer everything. Go to appointments, attend any consultative exam Social Security schedules, and open every letter the day it arrives.

Step 7 — The decision and appeals. A first decision commonly takes 3 to 6 months. If denied, you generally have 60 days to appeal: reconsideration, then a hearing in front of a judge, then the Appeals Council, then federal court. Many strong cases are approved at the hearing step.

Part 5 — Your Function Report Worksheet

Prepare your honest answers here before you fill in Social Security's form. Describe a hard day, not your best day — and explain what has changed since your condition began.

A typical day, from waking to bedtime — what you do, and what you can no longer do

Personal care — dressing, bathing, grooming, eating — what help do you need?

Meals, housework, and yard work — what you can do, what you had to stop, how long things take

Getting around — driving, riding, walking — limits on distance, standing, sitting, lifting

Shopping and money — can you shop alone, pay bills, count change, follow a budget?

Social life and hobbies — what you used to enjoy and what has changed

Concentration and memory — finishing tasks, following instructions, handling stress and changes

Pain and other symptoms — where, how often, what makes it better or worse, medication side effects

Part 6 — After an Approval

☐ SSDI: there is a 5-month waiting period from when your disability began before payments start; Medicare generally begins 24 months after SSDI payments start

- ☐ SSI: payments generally start from the month after you applied or became eligible; Medicaid in Texas usually follows SSI
- ☐ DAC: ask about Medicare after 24 months on DAC, and tell Social Security about marriage or work — both can affect DAC
- ☐ Report changes: returning to work, moving, or changes in income or living arrangements
- ☐ Keep your records: approval letters, payment information, and review notices (continuing disability reviews happen — keep medical care going)

Please read: This worksheet is an educational tool only. It is not legal, tax, medical, or financial advice, and Southern Oak Financial & Wellness is not a law firm and does not provide legal representation. Social Security rules change — confirm current details at ssa.gov or with Social Security before you act. There is no guarantee of approval for any benefit: only the Social Security Administration decides claims. Timelines are common ranges, not promises. This worksheet is for your family's personal use only — no refunds.

SOUTHERN OAK
Financial & Wellness • southernoakfw.org